

Government Auctions & Surplus

The government sells cars, property, and seized goods to the public — often well below retail — and holds billions in unclaimed money. Below are the official national sites. Tick the box once you’ve checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Use only official .gov sites and their named partners. Items sell “as-is,” so read every listing carefully and never pay a separate “membership” site for access to lists you can get free. Checking for unclaimed money is always free.

1 Start Here — The Official Hub

USA.gov links to every legitimate federal auction and sale in one place.

☐ USA.gov — Auctions & Sales

The official starting point for government auctions of cars, property, and seized goods.

→ www.usa.gov/auctions-and-sales

2 Buy Cars & Surplus Goods

Federal agencies sell vehicles, electronics, equipment, and more to the public.

☐ GSA Auctions

The main federal site for surplus cars, trucks, equipment, and goods from government agencies.

→ www.gsaauctions.gov

☐ GSA Fleet Vehicle Sales

The largest source of used government vehicles — tens of thousands of cars and trucks sold each year.

→ autoauctions.gsa.gov

☐ GovDeals & Public Surplus

Where most state and local agencies (police, schools, transit) sell vehicles and equipment.

→ www.govdeals.com

3 Seized & Forfeited Property

Property seized by federal agencies is sold to the public, including cars, jewelry, and sometimes real estate.

☐ U.S. Marshals Service Auctions

Assets seized in federal cases — vehicles, real estate, and luxury goods.

→ www.usmarshals.gov/assets/sales

☐ U.S. Treasury Auctions

Property forfeited for tax or other violations, sold to the public.

→ www.usa.gov/auctions-and-sales

4 Real Estate & Unclaimed Money

The government also sells homes and land — and may be holding money that belongs to you.

☐ Government Real Estate & Land Sales

GSA and the Bureau of Land Management sell homes, buildings, and land to the public.

→ www.usa.gov/real-estate-sales

☐ Find Unclaimed Money — Official Search

Check free for forgotten bank accounts, refunds, and unclaimed funds in your name through your state.

→ www.usa.gov/unclaimed-money

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Never pay a website a fee for “access” to government auction or unclaimed-money lists — the official .gov sites are free. Auction items are sold as-is with no warranty, so inspect or research before you bid.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Set a firm maximum bid based on the item’s real market value and don’t go over it. For cars, look up the make/model value first so you know what a good deal actually is.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Ask for your personalized auctions search

This guide covers the main national official sites. For local police auctions, county surplus sales, and your state’s unclaimed-money database, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we’ll point you to the right places.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
